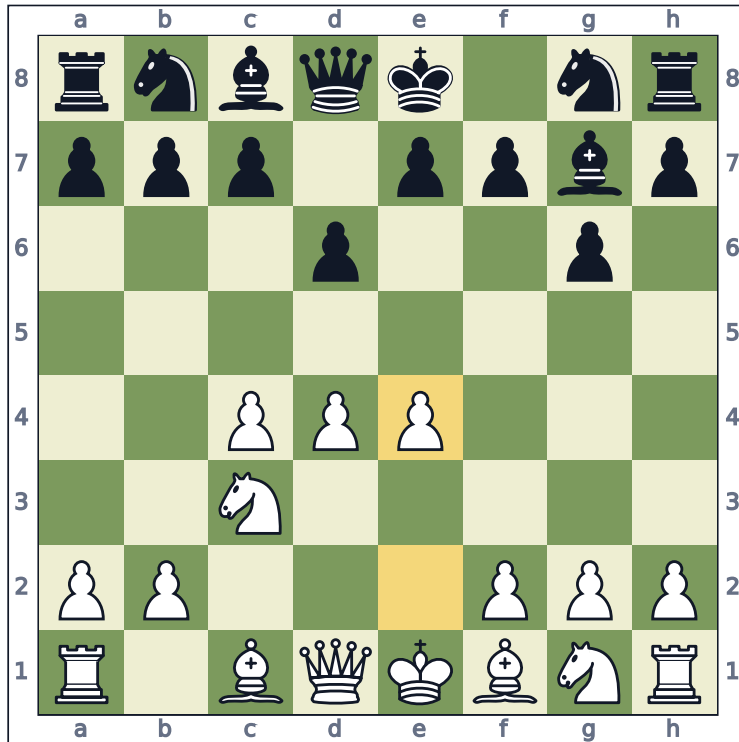


FLEXIBLE QUEEN'S PAWN AND INDIAN SETUPS

Modern Defense

ECO A42 | 6 named lines in this code



Featured opening position - gold marks the last move

IS IT A GOOD OPENING?

Good and fully playable. The position remains within a normal opening balance for both sides.

ENGINE SNAPSHOT

+0.56 for White. A shallow opening score is a guide, not a forced result.

GAME CHARACTER

Principled and instructive: development and central breaks lead naturally into the middlegame.

WHAT THIS OPENING IS

A42 covers Modern Defense. White establishes d4 while both sides keep several pawn structures available. The diagram uses the featured line Modern Defense: Averbakh System.

DEFINING ROUTE

1. d4 g6 2. c4 Bg7 3. Nc3 d6 4. e4

UNDERSTAND THE POSITION

What both sides are trying to achieve

WHITE'S GOALS

Support d4, complete development, and choose c4, e4, or a system setup according to Black's placement.

BLACK'S GOALS

Pressure d4, prevent an effortless e4 center, and choose a timely ...d5, ...c5, or ...e5 challenge.

PAWN BREAKS - THE ENGINE OF THE OPENING

The position is usually defined by c4/c5 or e4/e5. The side that prepares the break better gains the initiative.

PIECE MAP

Knights fight for e4 and d5; bishops should be developed according to the final pawn chain rather than by habit. Black's g7 bishop is aimed at the center and queenside.

WHAT USUALLY GOES WRONG

Automatic system moves can miss a tactical change in the center or allow the opponent an ideal break. Recheck the center after every opponent deviation; opening names do not make moves automatic.

POSITION SNAPSHOT

Black moves next. Material is level. Central markers: White pawn on c4, White pawn on d4, Black pawn on d6, White pawn on e4.

WHO SHOULD STUDY IT?

A strong practical family for players who want flexibility and familiar structures against several defenses.

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named A42 line

This section preserves all 6 names and defining routes assigned to A42 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

001 Modern Defense: Averbakh System

1. d4 g6 2. c4 Bg7 3. Nc3 d6 4. e4

002 Modern Defense: Averbakh Variation, Pseudo-Sämisch

1. d4 g6 2. c4 Bg7 3. e4 d6 4. Be3 Nf6 5. f3

003 Modern Defense: Kotov Variation

1. d4 g6 2. c4 Bg7 3. Nc3 d6 4. e4 Nc6

004 Modern Defense: Randspringer Variation

1. d4 g6 2. c4 Bg7 3. Nc3 d6 4. e4 f5

005 Pterodactyl Defense

1. Nf3 c5 2. c4 g6 3. d4 Bg7 4. e4 Qa5+ 5. Nc3 d6

006 Pterodactyl Defense: Central, Bogolubovia

1. d4 g6 2. c4 Bg7 3. e4 d6 4. Nc3 c5 5. Nge2 Qa5